

A Perspective on Web Scalability

Web scalability is a very vast topic of research, practices and experiments. In this article, we will discuss it in detail.

Web scalability is a vast topic for discussion. This article will discuss the story so far, followed by describing the tenets of Web scalability. Then it will offer a perspective on which direction it is headed.

The story so far

Let us first circle back to the OSI 7-layer network stack that we had studied in our undergraduate Networking-101 course.

In Figure 1, the top three layers are the soft layers, and the bottom three layers are the hardware-centric layers. The transport layer is at the heart of the soft and hard layers. When an application talks to the underlying hardware, the data flows from top to bottom and vice versa. The application layer is numbered as 'layer-7', the presentation layer as 'layer-6', and so on.

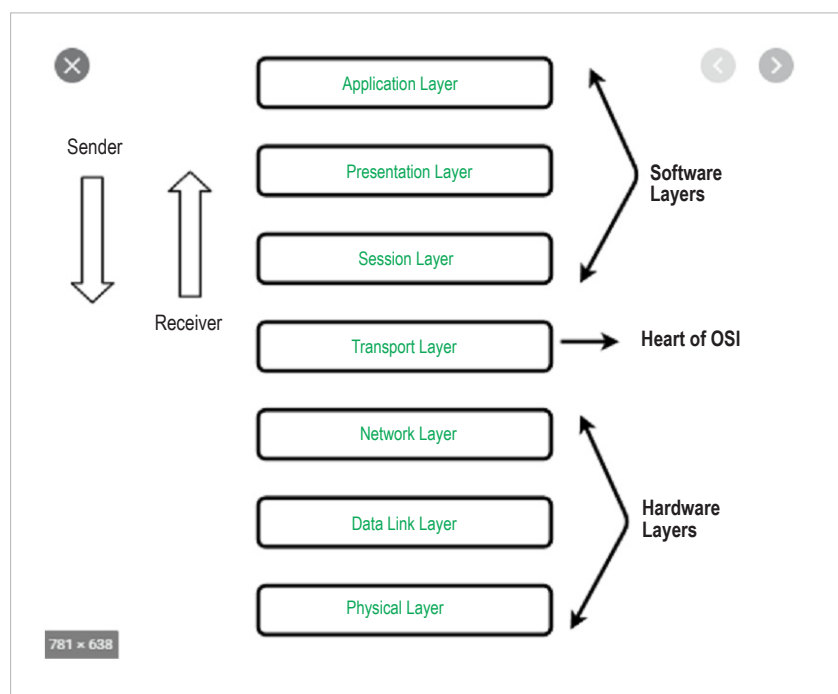


Figure 1: OSI 7-layer networking stack